

Guides

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Guides are demolab’s **reference layer** — the conventions you and the agent can lean on at any moment. They live inside the engine (`demolab-engine/guides/`), so they version with it and are always in force rather than run on demand. Ask the agent a guide’s name in capitals and it walks you through the relevant part; the canonical text is the Markdown source, linked in each section below.

RULES — the contract

RULES.md is the law of a demolab repo: the toolchain, the engine-versus-content **firewall** (what updates wholesale, and what’s yours), the schema a tool and an experiment must satisfy, and the step-by-step for adding a tool, an experiment, or a writing. When a convention has teeth it is numbered here as a §-rule, so everything else can cite it.

HOUSESTYLE — how a write-up reads

HOUSESTYLE.md governs the prose: sentence-level style, how math is set, how figures are captioned and cross-referenced, and how citations work — as numbered H-rules. You can extend or override any of it per-lab with a root `HOUSESTYLE.local.md`.

SLIDES — decks

SLIDES.md covers slide decks (`writings/*.slide.typ`): the Touying skeleton, sizing against the fixed canvas, the silent-overflow trap and the page-count check, and a named, liftable **layout catalog** you copy from rather than re-deriving a layout each time.

STRUCTURE — the file tree

STRUCTURE.md is the annotated map of the repository: what every directory and file is, and which rule governs it. It’s the fastest way to answer “where does this live, and why here?”

GLOSSARY — the vocabulary

GLOSSARY.md defines the terms precisely — tool, experiment, writing, deck, collection, artifact, provenance — and draws the line between the ones that are easy to confuse, like a **tool** versus an **experiment**.

SUPPORT — reaching a human

SUPPORT.md is the escape hatch: how to report a bug or ask a question when the agent and the guides don’t settle it between them.

Their on-demand counterpart — **runbooks** — has its own article in this collection.